

- ❖ Sericulture, or silk farming, is the cultivation of silkworms to produce silk.
- ❖ The silkworm filament secreted from the salivary gland of the larva helps us in producing silk.

Types of silk	Scientific name	Host plant
Mulberry silk	<i>Bombyx mori</i>	Mulberry
Eri silk	<i>Samia cynthia</i>	Castor
Tasar silk	<i>Antheraea</i> spp.	Arjun, Ber, Saal
Muga silk	<i>Antheraea assama</i>	Som, Sualu

- ❖ Female silk moths will lay up to 300 eggs at a time.
- ❖ About 2,000 – 5,000 cocoons are needed to make 450g of silk.
- ❖ The silkworm caterpillar builds its cocoon by producing and surrounding itself with a long, continuous fiber, or filament.
- ❖ Liquid secretions from two large glands within the insect emerge from the spinneret, a single exit tube in the head, hardening upon exposure to air and forming twin filaments composed of fibroin, a protein material.
- ❖ A second pair of glands secretes sericin, a gummy substance that cements the two filaments together.
- ❖ Because an emerging moth would break the cocoon filament, the larva is killed in the cocoon by steam or hot air at the chrysalis stage.
- ❖ Silk containing **sericin is called raw silk**

LAC CULTURE

- ❖ Lac is the resinous secretion of lac insects.
- ❖ It involves proper care of host plants, regular pruning of host plants, propagation, collection and processing of lac.
- ❖ **Scientific name:** *Laccifer lacca*
- ❖ **Order:** Hemiptera
- ❖ **Host plants:** Kusum, Ranjeeni (Khair) and Ber (Plum) trees. The insects live upon plant juice.
- ❖ Lac is a natural resin of animal origin.
- ❖ It is secreted by an insect, known as lac-insect.